That such is the limited application of the privileges and immunities clause seems now to be conceded by my brethren. But it is said that the freedom of respondents with which the petitioners have interfered is the "freedom to disseminate information concerning the provisions of the National Labor Relations Act, to assemble peace-

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U. S. 581; *West* v. *Louisiana,* 194 U. S. 258; *Twining* v. *New Jersey, supra; Palko* v. *Connecticut,* 302 U. S. 319.

The reason for this narrow construction of the clause and the consistently exhibited reluctance of this Court to enlarge its scope has been well understood since the decision of the *Slaughter-House Cases.* If its restraint upon state action were to be extended more than is needful to protect relationships between the citizen and the national government, and if it were to be deemed to extend to those fundamental rights of person and property attached to citizenship by the common law and enactments of the states when the Amendment was adopted, such as were described in *Corfield* v. *Coryell, supra,* it would enlarge Congressional and judicial control of state action and multiply restrictions upon it whose nature, though difficult to anticipate with precision, would be of sufficient gravity to cause serious apprehension for the rightful independence of local government. That was the issue fought out in the *Slaughter-House Cases,* with the decision against enlargement.

Of the fifty or more cases which have been brought to this Court since the adoption of the Fourteenth Amendment in which state statutes have been assailed as violating the privileges and immunities clause, in only a single case was a statute held to infringe a privilege or immunity peculiar to citizenship of the United States. In that one, *Colgate* v. *Harvey,* 296 U. S. 404, it was thought necessary to support the decision by pointing to the specific reference in the *Slaughter-House Cases, supra,* 79, to the right to pass freely from state to state, sustained as a right of national citizenship in *Crandall* v. *Nevada,* 6 Wall. 35, before the adoption of the Amendment.

The cases will be found collected in Footnote 2 of the dissenting opinion in *Colgate* v. *Harvey,* 296 U. S. 404, 445. To these should be added *Holden* v. *Hardy,* 169 U. S. 366; *Ferry* v. *Spokane, P. & S. R. Co.,* 258 U. S. 314; *New York ex rel. Bryant* v. *Zimmerman,* 278 U. S. 63; *Whitfield* v. *Ohio,* 297 U. S. 431; *Breedlove* v. *Suttles,* 302 U. S. 277; *Palko* v. *Connecticut,* 302 U. S. 319.